



Trust Skills, Not Portfolios.

Scora - Business Assumptions & Validation Research

Personas, commercial assumptions, experiments, and decision rules

Business folder

Product: Scora Team: Code Luck

Phase: Product Validation & Strategy Date: 27 July 2026

Priority personas

Persona	Situation	Highest-risk assumption
Early-career developer	Strong practical ability, weak platform history.	Will invest time in assessment and share results.
Responsible AI-assisted developer	Uses AI productively and can review, explain, debug, and maintain the result.	Values a strict process that distinguishes ownership from prompt-only output.
Prompt-dependent applicant	Can generate convincing output but lacks the claimed engineering understanding.	The assessment catches the gap before a client contract.
Non-technical startup founder	Needs a developer but cannot deeply assess code.	Can understand and act on Scora's report.
Technical lead at an SME	Needs faster shortlisting without lowering quality.	Scora saves senior-engineer screening time.

Business assumptions

- Problem: buyers cannot tell whether a polished artifact represents engineering ownership or AI dependence without understanding.
- Audience: startups and SMEs feel the pain strongly enough to adopt an external trust signal.
- Value: ownership evidence - explanation, debugging, security review, and live change - changes shortlisting more than another badge.
- Supply: capable developers accept a strict, role-relevant gate in exchange for access to a verified-only talent pool.
- Fairness: declared or detected AI use alone never causes failure; inability to meet the engineering gate does.
- Revenue: B2B search/report access or custom assessment is more viable initially than developer-only subscriptions.
- Operations: selective human review can preserve credibility without making unit economics impossible.

Competitive comparison and defensible gap

Alternative	What buyers receive today	Remaining decision gap	Scora's differentiated offer
Upwork / Fiverr	Profiles, portfolios, reviews, identity signals, and contract history.	Past activity and satisfaction do not prove that a developer currently understands and can maintain claimed code.	A verified-only pool gated by code explanation, debugging, live modification, and engineering judgment before discovery.
HackerRank / Codility	Structured tests, technical tasks, interviews, AI policies, and integrity controls.	Assessment evidence is usually tied to one hiring event rather than a reusable freelance trust identity.	A persistent Developer Passport with client-readable evidence, scope, confidence, recency, reassessment, and appeal history.
Toptal / curated agencies	High-touch screening and access to an admitted talent network.	The buyer may receive the admission outcome without granular, inspectable evidence of why a specific skill was verified.	Explainable evidence cards that show gate results and limits, then connect verified talent directly to client shortlisting.
GitHub / portfolios / certificates	Artifacts, activity, course completion, and self-presented proof of work.	The artifact can be genuine or AI-assisted, but it does not establish who can explain, change, secure, debug, and own it.	Artifact-linked ownership verification that permits responsible AI use but rejects dependence without demonstrated understanding.

What Scora adds that the alternatives do not combine

- A freelance discovery pool where technical verification is a prerequisite for verified visibility, not a badge placed beside unsupported claims.
- Persistent, client-readable evidence of current engineering ownership rather than only reputation history, a one-time test score, or a portfolio artifact.
- AI-aware assessment that accepts productive tool use while requiring explanation, hidden-bug diagnosis, live change, security reasoning, and maintainability judgment.
- Transparent scope, confidence, recency, reassessment, and appeal metadata so buyers can see what was verified and where the evidence stops.

Defensible positioning: Scora is not claiming that every component is individually unique. Its differentiated offer is the combination of an ownership gate, persistent explainable evidence, and verified freelance discovery in one workflow. This positioning must be validated through buyer interviews and side-by-side prototype tests.

Experiment backlog

Experiment	Artifact	Metric	Decision
Problem interviews	Interview guide + notes	Repeated pain, current workaround, cost of failure.	Narrow or reject segment if pain is rare.
Report comprehension	Two report prototypes	Correct interpretation and confidence.	Redesign before score-engine work.
Assessment concierge	Manual one-track assessment	Start/completion, reviewer time, usefulness.	Set time budget and review thresholds.
Client shortlist pilot	10 verified profiles	Time-to-shortlist, contact rate, qualified interviews.	Choose first paid workflow.
Pricing test	Three realistic packages	Commitment: call, pilot deposit, or signed LOI.	Avoid relying on stated willingness alone.